THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

2020W1 UBC Individual TA Report for ECON 101 L5D - Principles of Microeconomics (Bufang Duan)

Project Title: **2020W1 UBC TA Evaluations**

Course Audience: **60**
Responses Received: **13**
Response Ratio: **22%**

Report Comments

Recommended Minimum Response Rates

Class Size	Recommended Minimum Response Rates based on 80% confidence & ± 10% margin
< 10	75%
11 - 19	65%
20 - 34	55%
35 - 49	40%
50 - 74	35%
75 - 99	25%
100 - 149	20%
150 - 299	15%
300 - 499	10%
> 500	5%

Creation Date: **Sunday, September 12, 2021**

blue®

TA Questions

Question	N	n	SD	D	N	A	SA	N/A	IM	DI
The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance.	60	13	0	0	2	4	7	0	4.6	0.4
The TA was well-prepared for their duties.	60	13	0	0	1	3	9	0	4.8	0.3
The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment.	60	13	0	0	1	3	7	2	4.7	0.3
The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me.	60	13	0	1	3	3	6	0	4.3	0.5
The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter.	60	13	0	0	1	3	9	0	4.8	0.3
The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter.	60	13	0	0	1	3	9	0	4.8	0.3
The TA presented information clearly.	60	13	0	1	4	3	5	0	4.0	0.5
The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter.	60	13	0	0	1	5	7	0	4.6	0.3
The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas.	60	13	0	0	1	5	6	1	4.5	0.3
The TA treated me and other students with equal respect.	60	13	0	0	1	1	11	0	4.9	0.2
The TA's comments on my written work were helpful.	60	13	0	0	3	0	0	10	3.0	0.0
The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought.	60	13	0	0	3	5	5	0	4.2	0.4
The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable.	60	13	0	0	2	3	3	5	4.2	0.4
The TA made a very positive contribution to this course.	60	13	0	0	1	6	6	0	4.4	0.3

Question	%Favourable
The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance.	85%
The TA was well-prepared for their duties.	92%
The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment.	91%
The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me.	69%
The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter.	92%
The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter.	92%
The TA presented information clearly.	62%
The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter.	92%
The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas.	92%
The TA treated me and other students with equal respect.	92%
The TA's comments on my written work were helpful.	0%
The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought.	77%
The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable.	75%
The TA made a very positive contribution to this course.	92%

How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?

N	n	Very poor	Poor	Neutral	Good	Very Good	N/A	IM	DI
60	13	0	0	1	2	10	0	4.9	0.2

Question	%Favourable
How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?	92%

Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend?

Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend?		
Options	Count	Percentage
None	0	0%
Less than 25%	1	8%
25-50%	2	15%
51-75%	1	8%
Greater than 75%	9	69%

Which, if any, of the following did your Teaching Assistant do? (Please mark each element that is appropriate)

Options	Count
Led discussion-tutorial groups	12
Held office hours	8
marked examination(s)	4
marked essay(s)-assignment(s)	0
gave classroom lectures	2
conducted labs	0
responded to email	7
Respondent(s)	12

Considering everything, how would you rate this course?

N	n	Very poor	Poor	Neutral	Good	Very good	N/A	IM	DI
60	13	0	3	4	5	1	0	3.4	0.5

Question	%Favourable
Considering everything, how would you rate this course?	46%

Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of your teaching assistant's (TA's) teaching, attitudes to students, class atmosphere, or any other matters affecting the quality of instruction that you consider worthy of note.

Comments
very knowledgable in economics
Positive energy, extremely helpful
He was very enthusiastic about the subject matter and managed to make the class more interesting.
Bufang Duan is a very helpful TA. He is very quick at replying back to emails and ensures that all students are aware of the resources they have when in need of help. The class atmosphere is very positive and he routinely makes funny jokes related to Microeconomics to lighten the mood and help ease the students. He monitors the chatbox during the whole discussion time, which is very useful as he will answer each and individual question. During his office hours, he makes sure that every student has had a chance to ask a question before he allows for the same student to ask another question. This is very helpful as it gives a chance for everyone to get the help needed without staying for the whole duration.
Your friendly attitude and humour has really made the class atmosphere more engaging and enjoyable, and it makes students much more willing to come to class and learn. One thing I would mention as something you could improve in your teaching is that often when you go through examples, you tend to focus more on the "theoretical" aspect of questions, instead of actually going through the questions and putting in the numbers and showing us how you'd solve them. This makes it much harder to understand more tricky concepts and I feel like a lot of us would appreciate if you would instead actually show us the whole process of solving the questions.
I think that he was super engaging and did a amazing job. He made sure that everyone understood before continuing and was always willing to spend extra time if you didn't understand. He also was really good with coming up with analogies that make it easier to understand.
William clearly is very passionate about Economics and overall, he was very effective but sometimes I felt that there were too many questions to do in a short hour so there was only so much we could go over.
He showed empathy for students and helped tremendously in reviewing for exams or giving examination tips.
Always put in so much of his personal time to hold office hours and help students. He makes discussions engaging and does everything to answer each students question, and doesn’t move on until they understand it. Super positive, funny, kind, and smart!
I liked that William interacted with us in an informal way. He was very open, friendly and not at all intimidating. He assisted and conversed with us as if he was one of our peers and it made us very comfortable asking for help or clarification on the course material.
William was very outgoing and passionate about the subject matter. HE was readily available to answer students questions and worked his hardest to make sure we were successful and enjoying the course.

Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of the format and content of the course as they may have affected the teaching assistant's performance.

Comments
Having the class be online was a bit challenging but he made it work by using whiteboards and screen sharing.
Due to the fact that everything is online, it was hard to reach out for help. Bufang, however, always encouraged to ask him questions as he would always mention that it is his job to help the students. This was very helpful as there would be times where asking the Professor seemed too scary at first.
There were way too many questions that were given to the TA to answer during tutorial. This caused the TA to rush through solving them, and not really take the time to go through the entire mathematical process of answering the question (which makes it harder to understand what he's doing at times). Most times we still didn't even finish all of them, even if we were rushing. It would be better if we had fewer questions to solve, so that we could go more in–depth in answering them.
I think other than it being online as it is harder to engage with students, but even then he still did an amazing job!
He is so enthusiastic and is eager to take questions, leading to a positive impact.
The course content was confusing at times but I felt like the TA had explained it well.
William (Bufang) did a great job of being a teachers assistant even with unclear instructions and guidelines from the professor, he always tried his best to make things work for his students and put in his best effort to communicate with the professor.
I've noticed that although the discussions were recorded, having notes and graphs to refer to in addition to the discussion recording would be very helpful.
I think moving the discussion sessions onto Zoom was a good idea because the platform is more user–friendly.

Explanatory Note

Percent Favourable Rating

This is the percentage of respondents who rated the instructor a 4 or 5 (Agree or Strongly Agree).

Interpolated Median

The data collected for Student Evaluations of Teaching (SEoT) are ordinal in nature, with a natural order (from 1 to 5). While the mean may be used as a measure of central tendency for such data, it is not an appropriate or accurate representation of SEoT data (cf. Stark & Freishtat, 2014). The usual measure of central tendency for ordinal data is the median. As a result, we have been reporting the mean and the median for the last several years. After considerable thought and data modeling, we now believe that the interpolated median is the best representation of the data, since it takes the frequency distribution into account.

Consider the following example from 2015W, the two classes have identical mean (3.8). However, the instructor in class 2 received 77% favourable (4-5) ratings, compared to 53% for the instructor in class 1. The Interpolated median values of (3.7 and 4.2), much better reflects the distribution of the scores above and below their respective median. Furthermore, the interpolated median is better correlated with percent favourable rating; such that an interpolated median of 3.5 on a Likert scale of 1 to 5, corresponds to 50% favourable rating.

Frequency Distribution

Response for UMI	Class 1	Class 2
5 = Strongly agree	5	5
4 = Agree	3	5
3 = Neither agree nor disagree	6	0
2 = Disagree	1	2
1 = Strongly disagree	0	1
Mean	3.8	3.8
Median	4.0	4.0

Interpolated Median	3.7	4.2
Percent favourable rating	53%	77%

Dispersion Index

The dispersion Index is a measure of variability suitable for ordinal data (Rampichini, Grilli & Petrucci 2004). This dispersion index has values between zero and 1. A zero dispersion index indicates that all students in the section gave the same rating to the instructor. An index value of 1.0 is obtained when the class splits evenly between the two extreme values (Strongly Disagree & Strongly Agree), a very rare occurrence. In SEoT data at UBC, the index rarely exceeds 0.85, and mostly for evaluations not meeting the minimum recommended response rate.